

Arianna Ornaghi

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EMPLOYMENT

Hertie School, Assistant Professor of Economics (tenure-track), 2021-present
University of Warwick, British Academy Postdoctoral Research Fellow, 2019-2021
University of Warwick, Research Fellow, 2017-2019

AFFILIATIONS

Berlin School of Economics, Faculty Member, 2023-present
CEPR, Research Affiliate, 2021-present
CESifo, Research Network Affiliate, 2024-present
SCRIPTS, RU (Re-)Allocation co-PI, 2024-present
Verein für Socialpolitik, Member of the Committee for Political Economy, 2025-present

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, 2017
M.Sc. Economics and Social Sciences, Bocconi University, 2011
B.Sc. Economics and Social Sciences, Bocconi University, 2009

PUBLICATIONS

Nicola Mastrocco and Arianna Ornaghi. 2025. “Who Watches the Watchmen? Local News and Police Behavior in the United States.” **American Economic Journal: Economic Policy**, 17 (2): 285-318. *Winner of the European Economic Association Young Economist Award 2020.*

Elliott Ash, Daniel L. Chen, and Arianna Ornaghi. 2024. “Gender Attitudes in the Judiciary: Evidence from US Circuit Courts.” **American Economic Journal: Applied Economics**, 16 (1): 314-50.

Abhijit Banerjee, Amy Finkelstein, Rema Hanna, Benjamin A. Olken, Arianna Ornaghi, and Sudarno Sumarto. 2021. “The Challenges of Universal Health Insurance in Developing Countries: Experimental Evidence from Indonesia’s National Health Insurance” **American Economic Review**, 111 (9): 3035-63.

Greg Howard and Arianna Ornaghi. 2021. “Closing Time: The Local Equilibrium Effects of Prohibition.” **The Journal of Economic History**, 81(3), pp.792-830.

WORKING PAPERS

Johannes Böken, Mirko Draca, Nicola Mastrocco, and Arianna Ornaghi. 2025. “The Returns to Viral Media: the Case of US Campaign Contributions.” CEPR Discussion Paper No. 18337. **Conditionally Accepted at the Journal of the European Economic Association.**

Gregory J. Martin, Nicola Mastrocco, Joshua McCrain, and Arianna Ornaghi. 2025. “Media Consolidation.” CEPR Discussion Paper No. 19503. **R&R at the Review of Economics and Statistics.**

Nicola Mastrocco, Arianna Ornaghi, Matteo Pograxha, and Stephane Wolton. 2025. “Man Bites Dog: Editorial Choices and Biases in the Reporting of Weather Events.” CEPR Discussion Paper No. 18383. **R&R at the Journal of Public Economics.**

Arianna Ornaghi. 2019. “Civil Service Reforms: Evidence from US Police Departments.”

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

CRC Rationality and Competition, Project B08 co-PI (€245,000), 2025-2028
Russel Sage Foundation Presidential Grant in Behavioral Economics, with Elliott Ash and Daniel L. Chen (\$35,000), 2019-2021
British Academy Postdoctoral Research Fellowship (£345,000), 2019-2021
British Academy Small Research Grant, with Nicola Mastroiocco (£10,000), 2018
CAGE Research Fund Small Grant, with Greg Howard (£5,000), 2017
Sokoloff Dissertation Fellowship, Economic History Association (\$15,000), 2016
Jameel Fellowship in Poverty Alleviation and Development Economics, 2014-2015
Exploratory Travel and Data Grant, Economic History Association, 2015
George and Obie Shultz Fund, 2015-2016
James A. Berkovec Memorial Fund, 2013-2014
MIT Department of Economics Fellowship, 2012-2013

INVITED TALKS

2026: University of Oslo (scheduled)
2025: University of Lucerne, Freie Universität, ECARES (scheduled)
2024: Charles University Faculty of Law, Prague University of Economics and Statistics, ifo Institute, Rockwool Foundation Berlin, University of Potsdam, CEPR Media Plurality Webinar, POLECONUK Webinar
2023: University of Cologne, Newcastle Business School, ifo Institute, IEB University of Barcelona, ZEW Corporate Taxation and Public Finance
2022: Columbia University, Stockholm University, Texas A&M, Federal Communication Commission, LMU, Paris Empirical Political Economy Seminar
2021: University of York, New York University Political Science, New Economic School, London School of Economics
2020: SoDa Labs, Zurich Econ & Data Science Reading Group, Deep Learning Trends and Classics Reading Group, University of Rochester Wallis Institute of Political Economy, City University of London, Hertie School
Pre-2019: University of Glasgow, Arizona State University School of Politics and Global Studies, Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance, IIES Stockholm University, Bank of Italy, University of British Columbia, IESE Business School

CONFERENCE & WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

2025: Economics of Media Bias Workshop, Lancaster Text-as-Data Workshop, Benelux PECO, Transatlantic Economics of Crime Conference
2024: Economics of Media Bias Workshop, Warwick-Princeton-Yale-CEPR Political Economy Symposium, Media Bias and Political Polarization Conference
2023: Yale-TSE Regulating the Digital Economy Conference, IEB Political Economy Workshop, CEPR Workshop on Media, Technology, Politics, and Society
2022: AEA Meetings, IBEO Alghero Workshop, 4th Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Workshop
2021: AEA Meetings, Oslo Political Economy Workshop, Early-Career Behavioral Economics Conference, IEB Political Economy Workshop, Al Capone Conference, NBER SI Political Economy
2020: UEA Textual Analysis Workshop, Stockholm Workshop on Diversity and Inclusion, Economics of Crime Online Seminar, Economics of Discrimination & Disparities Online Seminar, Nottingham Workshop on the Economics of Gender Norms, EEA Congress
Pre-2019: EMUEA Meetings, PSE Conflict Workshop, OWL Economic History Workshop, Warwick Economic History Workshop, Quebec Political Economy Conference, Royal Economic Society, Barcelona GSE Summer Forum, APSA Conference, EALE Annual Conference, Economic History Association (poster session)

TEACHING

Hertie School

Master Thesis Supervision (~8 students per year), 2021-present
Economics II Economics & Politics (course, master-level), 2021-present
Economics of Media (course, master-level), 2021-present
Development Economics (course, master-level), 2022-present

University of Warwick

Research in Applied Economics, 2018-2022

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Teaching Assistant for edX Data Analysis for Social Sciences, 2017
Teaching Assistant for Graduate Political Economy, 2017
Kauffman Teaching Certificate Program, 2016
Teaching Assistant for Principles of Microeconomics, 2016
Teaching Assistant for the JPAL Summer Executive Education Program, 2015

OTHER PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Advising (PhD Students)

Anina Harter (2025); P. Sneha (ongoing); Konrad Doliensen (ongoing)

Defenses

Marita Freimane (KU Leuven, 2025)

Refereeing

Journals: American Economic Review, American Economic Review: Insights, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, Bulletin of Economic Research, Economic Journal, European Economic Review, Industrial and Labor Relations Review, International Review of Law and Economics, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Economic History, Journal of Economic Inequality, Journal of the European Economic Association, Journal of Health Economics, Journal of Law, Economics and Organization, Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics, Journal of Public Economics, Labour Economics, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, Review of Economic Studies, Social Choice and Welfare
Conferences: Congress of the European Economic Association (2024, 2025, 2026), Verein für Socialpolitik Annual Conference (2025), European Association of Law and Economics (2024)

School Service

Member of the MDS Admission Committee, 2022-2025
Member of Recruitment Committees, 2021-2022, 2022-2022, 2023-2024
Organizer of the Political Economy Lunch Series, 2022-2023, 2025-2026

Seminars and Workshops

Co-organizer of Economics of Media Bias Workshop, 2026
Co-organizer of the Workshop on the Political Economy of Identity, 2025
Co-organizer of the POLECONUK Webinar Series, 2020-2021
Organizer of the PEPE Research Days, Warwick University, 2017-2021

Last Updated: November 2025.